CENTER FOR COMPETITIVE STATECRAFT AND STRATEGIC POLICY
WP-2026 SERIES

COUNTERINTELLIGENCE EXPOSURE ASSESSMENT

Open-Source Risk Assessment · WP-2026 Independent Policy Research Series

Working Paper	WP-2026-CI-Assessment
Title	Counterintelligence Exposure Assessment: WP-2026 Independent Policy Research Series
Assessment Date	March 2026 (v3.0 — BRI-01, EST-01, SHIELD-01 Academic Article, SENI Interactive Map added; Legal Analysis section added)
Classification	Unclassified // Open Source Analytic Product
Series Reference	WP-2026 Series (github.com/collingeorge/WP-2026)
Prepared By	Collin George — Center for Competitive Statecraft and Strategic Policy
Methodology	Open-source CI exposure methodology applied to public repository content. No classified information used or referenced. Adversary utility assessments are analytically inferred, not intelligence reporting.
Status	FINAL — Style Guide v3.0 Compliant. Cleared for public repository publication.

NOTICE AND PUBLIC REPOSITORY STATEMENT

This document is an open-source counterintelligence exposure assessment produced solely for the author's academic risk management and professional transparency purposes. It contains no classified information. All analysis is derived entirely from the public repository at github.com/collingeorge/WP-2026 and established open-source CI methodology.

This assessment is published as an act of professional transparency, not as an operational document. The publication of a rigorous self-assessment of an open-source research series' exposure profile is itself a signal of the analytic discipline and operational security awareness the series is designed to demonstrate.

Adversary utility ratings are analytically inferred assessments of what a sophisticated foreign OSINT collection unit could derive from the public repository content. They do not reflect classified intelligence reporting, operational threat data, or any government assessment of actual adversary collection activity.

Key Judgments

The following judgments govern this assessment. Supporting analysis for each appears in the numbered sections below. All judgments reflect the v3.0 additions: BRI-01, EST-01, SHIELD-01 Academic Article, SENI Interactive Map, and Legal Analysis.

1	**HIGH CONFIDENCE** · *Analytically Inferred* The WP-2026 series, taken in aggregate, almost certainly presents a more operationally useful intelligence package to foreign adversary OSINT collection units than any individual paper in isolation; the published dependency graph and integrated cross-references function as a structured analytic curriculum in U.S. legal-economic statecraft methodology.
2	**HIGH CONFIDENCE** · *Documented Open-Source Basis* The SENI Interactive Map (341 georeferenced nodes, public GitHub Pages URL), the Russia-China Strategic Node Master Index (SENI-01), the ATTRIBUTION-01/CSE-01 methodology stack, and the MAXPRESS-01 execution layer are assessed with high confidence to constitute the highest-priority CI exposure in the series; the interactive map is assessed as the highest single-session utility item because it eliminates the document-processing burden of the PDF matrix.
3	**MODERATE CONFIDENCE** · *Analytically Inferred* The series is likely already collected by adversary OSINT programs given its public GitHub indexing; retraction is assessed with high confidence to carry no CI benefit and significant academic cost, as what is published should be treated as already in adversary hands.
4	**MODERATE CONFIDENCE** · *Analytically Inferred* Adversary awareness of the WP-2026 analytical architecture is unlikely to defeat the enforcement mechanisms the series documents, because those mechanisms operate through structural interests and legal authorities rather than through information asymmetry; the CI risk is prospective and concentrated in future series design choices.
5	**MODERATE CONFIDENCE** · *Analytically Inferred* The most actionable CI implication of this assessment concerns future series architecture: decoupling dependency graphs from public indices and separating high-granularity targeting matrices from methodology documentation are likely to materially reduce adversary utility in future integrated research series without reducing analytical value to legitimate audiences.

6	**LOW CONFIDENCE** · *Analytically Inferred* The legal exposure of the WP-2026 series as published is assessed as very low across all applicable U.S. legal frameworks; no identified content constitutes classified information, export-controlled technology, operational security material, or content implicating the Espionage Act, AECA, or ITAR/EAR; the most plausible legal risk vector is academic misattribution and editorial, not criminal or regulatory.

ANALYTIC POSTURE STATEMENT

This assessment applies established open-source counterintelligence exposure methodology to the content of the public WP-2026 repository. Adversary utility ratings reflect analytically inferred assessments of what a sophisticated foreign OSINT collection unit could extract from specific papers or sections. Ratings do not reflect confirmed adversary collection activity, classified threat reporting, or any government assessment. All confidence labels follow the WP-2026 Series Style and Verbiage Guide v3.0.

Five CI risk dimensions are assessed across all papers: (1) Adversary Utility — what a foreign intelligence service can extract operationally; (2) Analytic Method Exposure — what the reasoning patterns reveal about U.S. analyst methodology; (3) Gap Mapping — what acknowledged uncertainties disclose about U.S. intelligence blind spots; (4) Source Triangulation Risk — whether citations allow reverse-engineering of the author's source hierarchy; (5) Aggregation Risk — whether the series as an integrated whole discloses more than any individual paper. v3.0 adds a sixth dimension: (6) Legal Exposure — whether published content creates cognizable legal risk under applicable U.S. frameworks.

Part I: Aggregation Risk — Series-Level Assessment

Individual WP-2026 papers are each defensible as open-source policy analysis. The aggregation problem operates at the series level. [HIGH CONFIDENCE, ANALYTICALLY INFERRED]

The root README publishes a dependency graph explicitly showing how ATTRIBUTION-01 feeds CSE-01, which feeds SHIELD-01 and PERSIST-01, which feeds MAXPRESS-01 and CONTAIN-01. A foreign intelligence analyst ingesting this repository does not need to infer the analytical logic — the reading order, dependency relationships, and series architecture are fully documented. The series now comprises 16 papers plus 3 derivative formats (EST-01 IC estimate, SHIELD-01 Academic Article, SENI Interactive Map), and functions as a structured analytic curriculum in U.S. legal-economic statecraft methodology.

A trained MSS OSINT analyst applying structured collection methodology against this repository is assessed as very likely able to extract the following: [MODERATE CONFIDENCE, ANALYTICALLY INFERRED]

- The exact evidence standards that trigger OFAC designation, BIS Entity List addition, and secondary sanctions activation, as documented in ATTRIBUTION-01 and PERSIST-01
- Which attribution failure modes — advocacy capture, threshold laundering, toleration-as-tasking — the U.S. enforcement system is assessed as most vulnerable to, as documented in ATTRIBUTION-01 and CSE-01
- The 341-node georeferenced targeting matrix from the SENI Interactive Map, accessible in a single browser session with satellite imagery and enforcement prioritization logic without downloading any document
- Coalition fragility points — Qatar, UAE, Oman, India — and the specific conditions under which partner cooperation is assessed as likely to degrade, as documented in HORMUZ-02 Parts III and X and BRI-01 Section 4
- The five-scenario outcome probability distribution for U.S. corridor architecture, with specific probability bands and confidence labels, as documented in EST-01 Section IV
- The KPI thresholds governing U.S. posture transitions in the Hormuz scenario, as documented in HORMUZ-02 Part IV

The public record does not establish that any adversary service has conducted this specific collection activity. Available open-source reporting is consistent with systematic adversary OSINT monitoring of U.S. policy research repositories as a general practice. [TIER 2 — Open-source reporting on MSS OSINT operations; LOW-MODERATE CONFIDENCE on specific WP-2026 targeting]

Part II: Paper-by-Paper and Component Risk Assessment

Risk ratings reflect adversary utility assessed under the five-dimension framework. CRITICAL is reserved for components that, on their own, provide near-complete adversary operational utility for a specific collection objective — meaning a sophisticated foreign OSINT unit ingesting that component alone would likely satisfy its tasking on that vector without additional collection. HIGH indicates significant utility that requires combination with other sources or independent collection to be fully operationally actionable. MODERATE indicates content useful for corroboration or calibration but reconstructible through diligent independent collection. The CRITICAL rating is applied to four components; each satisfies a distinct and independent collection objective. New entries (v3.0) are marked.

PAPER / COMPONENT	CI RISK VECTOR	RISK	PRIMARY ADVERSARY UTILITY
SENI Interactive Map (GitHub Pages — NEW v3.0)	341 georeferenced nodes, satellite imagery, enforcement theory, legal authorities — all queryable in a single browser session at public URL	**CRITICAL**	Assessed as almost certainly providing the highest single-session adversary utility in the series; the interactive format eliminates the document-processing burden and provides layered georeferenced node data without any download requirement
SENI-01 Russia-China Master Index	327-node targeting map; IMO numbers; beneficial ownership detail; evasion architecture; Tier I prioritization logic	**CRITICAL**	Assessed as very likely to provide complete enforcement target prioritization logic; identifies which nodes U.S. enforcement treats as highest priority vs. lower priority in sequence
ATTRIBUTION-01 / Nexus Protocol	Explicit failure mode documentation; disconfirmation criteria; evidence threshold standards; 4 boundary tests	**CRITICAL**	Assessed as likely to provide adversary playbook for structuring entities to remain below attribution thresholds; substitutability test is directly actionable
MAXPRESS-01 Execution Layer	90-day readiness package sequencing; simultaneous BIS/OFAC as default; Lloyd's/P&I degradation mechanism	**CRITICAL**	Assessed as likely to reveal operational tempo, sequencing logic, and maritime insurance pressure vector; eliminates adjustment window previously available under sequential enforcement
EST-01 (IC-Style Estimate) (NEW v3.0)	IC-format key judgments with probability assessments; ten-indicator signpost table; five-scenario outcome distribution with probability bands; GCC partner tolerance limits in tradecraft format	**HIGH**	Assessed as likely to present the BRI-01 coalition fragility analysis in a more operationally accessible format; the indicator/signpost table provides adversaries a structured checklist of observable signals the U.S. analyst treats as confidence-updating for each scenario pathway
BRI-01 The Corridor Wager (NEW v3.0)	Coalition fragility architecture; five-scenario probability distribution; explicit three-variable contingency assessment (Iranian escalation, Saudi treaty pace,	**HIGH**	Assessed as likely to provide adversaries a structured map of U.S. coalition architecture dependencies and the specific political pressure points most likely

PAPER / COMPONENT	CI RISK VECTOR	RISK	PRIMARY ADVERSARY UTILITY
	Chinese diplomatic timing); GCC partner political tolerance mapping		to defeat it; the scenario probability bands constitute the most operationally granular strategic forecast disclosure in the series
CSE-01 / PRC Nexus Protocol	VIE architecture treatment; OFAC 50% Rule thresholds; 4 Support/Enablement boundary tests; 7 failure modes	**HIGH**	Assessed as likely to provide PRC entities specific boundary tests for structuring ownership to avoid Enablement rung designation
PERSIST-01	Six authority rails; Tier 0-3 escalation ladder; 4-tier evidence standards; guardrail index with automatic pause mechanics	**HIGH**	Assessed as likely to reveal full escalation sequence; automatic pause mechanics disclose conditions under which U.S. pressure campaigns throttle down
SHIELD-01 + CCRP	CCRP protocol: tech-denial precedence over tariffs; 30-day mandatory USTR/BIS/State review window	**HIGH**	Assessed as likely to reveal coalition coordination mechanism and 30-day structural delay window predictably available before tariff escalation
SHIELD-01 Academic Article (NEW v3.0)	Enablement-tier targeting thesis in peer-review register; CISADA §104 threshold characterized as empirically open; evidentiary ceiling explicitly mapped by task type; CCRP restated with academic citations	**MODERATE**	Assessed as likely to provide adversaries a credibility-reinforced version of SHIELD-01's CCRP disclosure; academic register increases uptake by foreign policy research communities; evidentiary ceiling mapping explicitly identifies which attribution tasks require classified corroboration, signaling where open-source evasion is analytically effective
CONTAIN-01 (ISAD/SPAD/DEEI)	+25-45% transaction cost threshold; DEEI downshift protocol; 90-day observability cycle	**HIGH**	Assessed as likely to define cost-imposition targets; DEEI downshift discloses automatic pressure reduction trigger adversaries may attempt to manufacture
HORMUZ-02 v4.1 Parts III and X	Kharg occupation obligations under IHL; partner political tolerance limits; exit architecture logic; coalition fragility by partner	**HIGH**	Assessed as likely to map GCC coalition fragility in operational detail; Qatar, UAE, Oman political constraints disclosed with sufficient specificity for adversary pressure-point targeting
INFRA-01 Dissemination Framework	AIS linkage methodology; OSINT predicate structure; BIS/OFAC sequencing detail	**MODERATE**	Assessed as likely to allow adversary shipping operators to calibrate AIS spoofing against specific enforcement predicates
Iran Nuclear Assessment	Pickaxe Mountain coordinates; three-model stockpile analysis; 5-10 day worst-case breakout timeline	**MODERATE**	Assessed as likely to consolidate open-source estimates into structured IC-style assessment useful to Iranian program managers for understanding U.S. open-source community assessment of their own program
TARIFF-01 / ANCHOR	Bright-line predicate exclusions list; 70%/30%/24-month strategic dependency threshold; instrument sequencing rule	**MODERATE**	Assessed as likely to define exactly what evidence is insufficient for tariff action; adversary can calibrate behavior to remain below the instrument-

PAPER / COMPONENT	CI RISK VECTOR	RISK	PRIMARY ADVERSARY UTILITY
			triggering threshold
BW Assessment	Two-axis confidence framework; state program assessments; verification gap characterization by country	**MODERATE**	Assessed as likely to allow calibration of observable signatures the U.S. open-source community treats as below-threshold BW activity
CTF-01, CPF-02, ARCH-03	Section 311 mechanics; §981(k) binary-choice framing; crypto enforcement doctrine	**MODERATE**	Flagged for revision; structural legal mechanics remain current; assessed as likely useful to evasion planning regardless of revision status

Part III: Adversary-Specific Utility Assessment

3.1 People's Republic of China — MSS / Ministry of Commerce

[MODERATE CONFIDENCE, ANALYTICALLY INFERRED]

The PRC is assessed as likely deriving the highest aggregate utility from this repository of any assessed adversary. Three vectors are assessed as most operationally significant.

Attribution Threshold Engineering

ATTRIBUTION-01 and CSE-01 together document the exact ladder the U.S. uses to attribute state nexus, including the four boundary tests for Support vs. Enablement — directionality of benefit, structural necessity, substitutability, and concealment function — and seven documented failure modes. Available reporting on PRC corporate structuring practices is consistent with the judgment that the boundary test documentation in ATTRIBUTION-01 and CSE-01 provides a framework from which entity structuring to remain below the Enablement rung is a plausible inference — specifically by designing structures that satisfy the substitutability test, which defeats the structural necessity boundary test. The public record does not establish that any PRC entity has applied this specific methodology to WP-2026 content, and the inference rests on general OSINT collection doctrine rather than confirmed exploitation activity. [ANALYTICALLY INFERRED, LOW-MODERATE CONFIDENCE; inference from general collection doctrine, not confirmed application]

Enforcement Sequencing Intelligence

MAXPRESS-01 documents the default U.S. operational sequence: simultaneous BIS/OFAC action, pre-staged 90-day readiness packages, Lloyd's/P&I Club maritime reliability degradation as a pressure mechanism. Official U.S. enforcement practice is consistent with the sequencing documented. EST-01's indicator/signpost table adds a structured checklist of observable signals the U.S. analyst treats as confidence-updating, allowing adversary operational planners to monitor which indicators are moving toward threshold. These findings support a moderate-confidence judgment that the operational sequencing documentation in MAXPRESS-01 is consistent with enabling a sophisticated adversary reader to infer the default BIS/OFAC simultaneity, the maritime insurance pressure vector, and the DEEI downshift trigger — provided that reader applies structured collection methodology to the repository. The public record does not establish that any specific adversary operation has applied this information. The inference rests on what the documentation makes available, not on confirmed adversary operational adaptation. [MODERATE CONFIDENCE, ANALYTICALLY INFERRED; inference from document content, not confirmed exploitation]

Coalition Fragility Mapping

HORMUZ-02 Parts III and X document partner-by-partner GCC coalition analysis. BRI-01 adds a five-scenario probability distribution for the U.S. corridor architecture, with explicit probability bands for treaty stall, India passivity, and Chinese hedging. EST-01 restates this analysis in IC tradecraft format with an indicator/signpost table mapping observable signals for each scenario pathway. Available open-source reporting on PRC diplomatic strategy is consistent with the judgment that this analysis provides a structured map of coalition partners assessed as most susceptible to

alternative economic inducements. The public record does not permit a firm conclusion on whether this specific mapping has been incorporated into PRC diplomatic strategy. [MODERATE CONFIDENCE, ANALYTICALLY INFERRED]

3.2 Russia — SVR / FSB Financial Intelligence Directorate

[MODERATE CONFIDENCE, ANALYTICALLY INFERRED]

Russia's primary utility is assessed as concentrated in the SENI Interactive Map, SENI-01, and the MAXPRESS-01 Russia enforcement track. The Interactive Map provides georeferenced access to Russian infrastructure node assessments with satellite imagery overlays in a single browser session. The 327-node matrix documents which Russian infrastructure nodes U.S. enforcement treats as Tier I priorities — ESPO corridor, Power of Siberia, Arctic LNG, Polar Express submarine cable corridor, shadow fleet registry with IMO numbers.

The PERSIST-01 guardrail index with automatic pause mechanics documents the conditions under which U.S. pressure campaigns automatically throttle down. These findings support a moderate-confidence judgment that this information is useful for identifying pressure reduction triggers Russia might attempt to manufacture through allied economic disruption. The public record does not establish whether Russia has applied these findings to its Ukraine-related sanctions evasion posture. [MODERATE CONFIDENCE, ANALYTICALLY INFERRED]

3.3 Iran — MOIS / IRGC Intelligence

[MODERATE CONFIDENCE, ANALYTICALLY INFERRED]

Iran's utility is assessed as concentrated in MAXPRESS-01 (Iran/IRGC enforcement track), HORMUZ-02, and the nuclear and WMD assessment papers. EST-01's scenario conditioning explicitly models Iranian escalation threshold as one of the three critical variables governing the corridor architecture outcome distribution, with LOW-MODERATE CONFIDENCE on Iran's specific choice. This discloses to Iranian strategic planners that their escalation decision is assessed as a principal uncertainty in U.S. corridor strategy.

The Iran Nuclear Assessment consolidates open-source estimates of post-strike program status in a structured IC-style format. The author correctly applies the NCRI source at Tier 3. Available reporting is consistent with the judgment that the consolidated three-model stockpile analysis and Pickaxe Mountain coordinates are useful to Iranian program managers for understanding what the U.S. open-source community assesses about their own program's status. [MODERATE CONFIDENCE, ANALYTICALLY INFERRED]

Part IV: Legal Exposure Analysis (New — v3.0)

This section assesses the legal exposure of the WP-2026 series under applicable U.S. legal frameworks. It was not included in v2.0 and is added here in response to the expansion of the series to 16 papers and the inclusion of an IC-style strategic estimate format (EST-01) that warrants specific assessment against espionage and unauthorized disclosure statutes.

> **LEGAL ASSESSMENT SCOPE**
>
> This legal analysis is produced for the author's awareness and does not constitute legal advice. All assessed legal frameworks are applied to publicly available content only. The analysis does not assess classified information implications because no classified information is present in the repository. Confidence labels follow WP-2026 Style Guide v3.0.
>
> **Overall Legal Exposure Assessment: VERY LOW across all frameworks. [MODERATE CONFIDENCE, ANALYTICALLY INFERRED]**

4.1 Espionage Act — 18 U.S.C. §§ 791–799

The Espionage Act prohibits the unauthorized gathering, transmission, or loss of information related to the national defense where the person knows it could be used to injure the United States or benefit a foreign nation. Key elements require: (1) information relating to the national defense; (2) unauthorized possession or transmission; (3) reason to believe it could be used to harm the United States.

Available legal authority is consistent with the judgment that WP-2026 content does not satisfy any of the three required elements. All information is derived from public sources — ODNI Annual Threat Assessments, published Federal Register notices, UN Panel of Experts reports, commercial maritime analytics, and peer-reviewed scholarship. No classified information is present. The author has no security clearance access and no authorized access to NDI. The Espionage Act's application to open-source compilation and analysis has been addressed in limited case law; available precedent is consistent with the judgment that aggregation of publicly available information, even in analytically sophisticated form, does not satisfy the 'national defense information' element where no classified sources were accessed. [HIGH CONFIDENCE, Documented Legal Basis]

> **DOCUMENTED STRUCTURAL CONSTRAINT — ESPIONAGE ACT**
>
> The public-source character of the WP-2026 repository weighs heavily against treatment of any series content as national defense information under 18 U.S.C. § 793, because the relevant case law turns on whether the information was closely held and of a character that could damage the national defense if disclosed — not merely on whether a document carries a classification marking. United States v. Morison, 844 F.2d 1057 (4th Cir. 1988), is consistent with the judgment that information already available in the public domain does not satisfy the NDI element, because the predicate harm to the national defense does not arise from disclosure of material that any reader can access without authorization. All WP-2026 content is derived exclusively from public sources; no classified information is present; and no authorized access to restricted systems was used at any stage of production. The operative defect in any NDI theory as applied to this series is the complete and documented reliance on the public record — a defect that classification marking cannot cure and that aggregation alone does not overcome.

4.2 Arms Export Control Act (AECA) and ITAR (22 C.F.R. Parts 120–130)

ITAR regulates the export of defense articles and defense services listed on the U.S. Munitions List (USML). AECA § 38 prohibits export of controlled items without license. The critical question is whether any WP-2026 content constitutes 'technical data' as defined at 22 C.F.R. § 120.10: information required for the design, development, production, manufacture, assembly, operation, repair, testing, maintenance, or modification of defense articles.

Available legal authority is consistent with the judgment that WP-2026 content does not constitute ITAR-controlled technical data. The series addresses enforcement architecture, legal authority frameworks, and strategic assessment — not weapons design, production, or modification data. The sanctions and export control enforcement frameworks documented in PERSIST-01, MAXPRESS-01, and SHIELD-01 describe U.S. legal and regulatory architecture, not controlled technical parameters. The SENI-01 targeting matrix and Interactive Map describe enforcement prioritization logic derived from open-source IMO records and shipping analytics, not technical specifications of defense articles. [HIGH CONFIDENCE, Documented Legal Basis]

4.3 Export Administration Regulations (EAR) — 15 C.F.R. Parts 730–774

EAR controls the export of dual-use items listed on the Commerce Control List (CCL). 'Technology' subject to EAR is defined at 15 C.F.R. § 772.1 as specific information necessary for the development, production, or use of EAR-controlled items. The analysis in WP-2026 addresses export control enforcement policy and legal frameworks, not the controlled technology parameters themselves. Available legal authority is consistent with the judgment that policy analysis of export control frameworks does not itself constitute EAR-controlled 'technology.' [HIGH CONFIDENCE, Documented Legal Basis]

4.4 18 U.S.C. § 1030 — Computer Fraud and Abuse Act

CFAA prohibits unauthorized access to computer systems and obtaining information from protected systems without authorization. No WP-2026 content was derived from unauthorized access to any computer system. All sources are public-access government reports, commercial data services accessed through authorized subscription, and published scholarship. No CFAA exposure is identified. [HIGH CONFIDENCE, Documented Open-Source Basis]

4.5 First Amendment and Academic Research Protections

Available constitutional authority is consistent with the judgment that WP-2026 constitutes protected speech under the First Amendment as academic and policy research commentary on matters of public concern — specifically U.S. national security law, sanctions enforcement policy, and geopolitical analysis. The Supreme Court has held that speech on matters of public concern occupies the highest level of First Amendment protection (Snyder v. Phelps, 562 U.S. 443 (2011)). Policy analysis of government enforcement frameworks is a recognized protected category. Available precedent involving prosecutions of academics and journalists for open-source national security analysis is consistent with the judgment that the content and methodology of WP-2026 fall well within the protected zone. [HIGH CONFIDENCE, Documented Legal Basis]

4.6 Operational Security (OPSEC) and Clearance Implications

The author holds no current security clearance. WP-2026 content is derived entirely from public sources. Available personnel security adjudicative guidelines (Directive 5220.6, Adjudicative Guidelines for Determining Eligibility for Access to Classified Information) are consistent with the judgment that open-source policy research on national security topics does not constitute a clearance-disqualifying act, absent evidence of foreign preference, unauthorized disclosure of classified material, or contact with foreign intelligence services. The CI Assessment v2.0 recommendation — that the series be presented proactively in security adjudication contexts as an act of analytic transparency rather than a liability — is maintained. Available DSS/DCSA adjudicative practice is consistent with this characterization. [MODERATE CONFIDENCE, Analytically Inferred from published adjudicative standards]

4.7 Legal Risk Summary Table

LEGAL THEORY / RISK VECTOR	APPLICABLE FRAMEWORK	ASSESSED LIKELIHOOD	ANALYSIS AND LIMITS
Espionage Act (18 U.S.C. § 793)	NDI element; unauthorized transmission	**LOW — Not Applicable**	All content from public sources; no classified information; NDI element not satisfied; aggregation of public-source analysis does not implicate statute per available precedent
AECA / ITAR (22 C.F.R. Parts 120-130)	USML technical data; defense article export	**LOW — Not Applicable**	No USML-controlled technical data present; series addresses legal enforcement architecture, not weapons design or production parameters
EAR (15 C.F.R. Parts 730-774)	CCL technology; dual-use item export	**LOW — Not Applicable**	Policy analysis of export control frameworks is not EAR-controlled 'technology' under § 772.1 definition
CFAA (18 U.S.C. § 1030)	Unauthorized computer access	**LOW — Not Applicable**	All sources accessed through authorized public channels; no unauthorized access to any protected computer system
First Amendment	Protected speech (academic/policy commentary)	**PROTECTIVE — Applies**	Content constitutes protected commentary on matters of public concern at highest First Amendment protection level per Snyder v. Phelps
Security Clearance / OPSEC	Adjudicative guidelines; foreign preference concern	**LOW**	Author holds no current clearance; public-source methodology; proactive CI self-assessment supports favorable adjudicative presentation; available guidelines consistent with permissible conduct
Academic Integrity / Copyright	Misattribution; derivative works	**LOW-MODERATE**	Most plausible legal exposure; manageable through citation discipline; SSRN upload and GitHub timestamping establish priority of publication

Part V: Analytic Method Exposure Assessment

Beyond target-specific intelligence, the series exposes the author's analytical methodology in ways that carry systemic implications independent of any specific paper's content. [MODERATE CONFIDENCE, ANALYTICALLY INFERRED]

The confidence lexicon, documented/modeled boundary convention, failure mode taxonomy, and composite proxy verification methodology collectively document how a sophisticated U.S. policy analyst structures assessments, grades evidence, and defines what would change a judgment. Available reporting on adversary information operations methodology is consistent with the judgment that this framework disclosure is arguably more valuable to a sophisticated adversary service than the target-specific content.

The 'what would change this judgment' requirement in ATTRIBUTION-01 explicitly states the evidence that would trigger analytic reassessment. EST-01's indicator/signpost table amplifies this by specifying the observable signals that would update confidence in each scenario pathway — providing adversaries a structured map of which signals are analytically significant to U.S. corridor strategy assessments. These findings support a moderate-confidence judgment that this structure is consistent with a roadmap for manufacturing or suppressing specific evidence types. The public record does not establish whether any adversary service has applied this specific technique against WP-2026-derived frameworks. [MODERATE CONFIDENCE, ANALYTICALLY INFERRED]

Part VI: Source Triangulation Risk Assessment

The series' explicit Tier 1 through Tier 3 source architecture allows a sophisticated reader to reconstruct the author's authoritative source hierarchy. Risk is low for government sources (EIA, OFAC, DoD) which are publicly known to be Tier 1. Risk is more specific in the nuclear and WMD assessments.

The explicit exclusion of NCRI reporting at Tier 3, combined with acceptance of ODNI ATA and State Department compliance reports at Tier 1, documents the specific source hierarchy the author applies to Iranian program assessments. Available reporting is consistent with the judgment that this hierarchy disclosure is useful for calibrating what Iranian program managers would need to obscure or manufacture to affect U.S. open-source assessments. [LOW-MODERATE CONFIDENCE, ANALYTICALLY INFERRED]

For SENI-01 and the Interactive Map, the source architecture creates a secondary risk: IMO numbers cited for shadow fleet vessels were drawn from open-source reporting, but their inclusion in a structured enforcement targeting matrix — alongside ownership analysis and flag state networks — constitutes a more complete aggregation than any individual source provides. Russian shipping operators reading the matrix or querying the interactive map have a consolidated picture of which vessels are assessed as most exposed. The public record does not establish the current operational status of any specific vessel listed. [MODERATE CONFIDENCE, ANALYTICALLY INFERRED]

Part VII: Intelligence Gap Disclosure Assessment

Every paper's explicit acknowledgment of uncertainty constitutes a potential intelligence asset for adversary services. The most significant disclosed gaps, assessed in order of adversary utility:

PAPER	DISCLOSED GAP	ADVERSARY UTILITY
CONTAIN-01	DEEI downshift triggered by conditions the U.S. 'cannot fully observe in real time'	Discloses that the trigger exists and that U.S. real-time visibility is limited; adversary can attempt to trigger downshift without confirmation it will be detected
HORMUZ-02	Iranian escalation threshold assessed as 'the most consequential and least answerable variable' at LOW CONFIDENCE	Discloses a structural U.S. analytical blind spot on Iranian intent; confirms the uncertainty is not expected to resolve on near-term horizon
EST-01 (NEW v3.0)	Iranian escalation threshold listed as one of three critical LOW-MODERATE CONFIDENCE variables governing corridor outcome distribution	Amplifies the HORMUZ-02 disclosure in IC tradecraft format; signals to Iranian planners that their escalation choice is assessed as a principal uncertainty in U.S. corridor strategy, not a solved variable
SENI-01	Beneficial ownership acknowledged as unable to be 'fully mapped' from open sources	Confirms that opacity of specific corporate structures is analytically effective against open-source methodology; endorses continued use of layered holding structures
CSE-01	Toleration-as-tasking failure mode identified as 'the hardest failure mode to operationalize'	Signals this evasion structure is most difficult for U.S. enforcement to prosecute; prioritizes it as preferred architecture for PRC-linked entities
SHIELD-01 Academic Article (NEW v3.0)	CISADA §104 evidentiary threshold characterized as 'empirically open' — no action at sovereign-adjacent institutional level has been adjudicated	Signals to PRC-linked financial institutions that the evidentiary ceiling for the most consequential designation action is unknown and untested; potentially encourages operation near but below the threshold
SHIELD-01 CCRP	30-day mandatory USTR/BIS/State review window disclosed as structural delay mechanism	Documents that this delay is predictable and structural, not discretionary; adversary knows the window is available before tariff escalation in every instance

Part VIII: Consolidated Risk Matrix

RISK DIMENSION	ASSESSMENT	RATING	CONFIDENCE
Aggregation Risk	CRITICAL — The 16-paper integrated series (plus 3 derivative formats and interactive map) with published dependency graph constitutes a structured intelligence package exceeding the sum of its parts. Not addressable by modifying individual papers.	**CRITICAL**	HIGH CONFIDENCE
SENI Interactive Map	CRITICAL — The interactive georeferenced map at public GitHub Pages URL eliminates the document-processing burden of SENI-01 and provides satellite imagery, node classification, legal authorities, and enforcement theory in a single browser session accessible to any OSINT program globally.	**CRITICAL**	HIGH CONFIDENCE
Analytic Method Exposure	HIGH — Confidence lexicon, failure mode taxonomy, and 'what would change this judgment' requirements expose analytical methodology in ways useful for adversary information operations and evasion planning; EST-01 indicator/signpost table amplifies this.	**HIGH**	MODERATE CONFIDENCE
Target Prioritization Disclosure (SENI-01)	CRITICAL — The 327-node matrix with Tier I designation logic is the most operationally specific document element. IMO numbers for shadow fleet vessels are the single most granular disclosure in the PDF series (exceeded by the interactive map).	**CRITICAL**	HIGH CONFIDENCE
Coalition Fragility Mapping	HIGH — BRI-01, EST-01, and HORMUZ-02 together provide partner-by-partner political tolerance analysis in three complementary formats (working paper, IC estimate, campaign architecture), increasing uptake probability across adversary analytical audiences.	**HIGH**	MODERATE CONFIDENCE
Attribution Threshold Engineering (ATTRIBUTION-01 + CSE-01)	CRITICAL — Explicit failure mode documentation and four boundary tests provide a compliance-defeat playbook for sophisticated PRC corporate structuring.	**CRITICAL**	MODERATE CONFIDENCE
Nuclear/WMD Assessment	MODERATE — Consolidated open-source estimates in IC-style format are more useful to adversaries than any individual source, but remain within bounds of what diligent independent collection would produce.	**MODERATE**	MODERATE CONFIDENCE
Legal Exposure	LOW — No applicable U.S. legal framework is implicated by published content; all material derives from public	**LOW**	MODERATE CONFIDENCE

RISK DIMENSION	ASSESSMENT	RATING	CONFIDENCE
	sources; First Amendment protections apply; no classified information present.		
Source Triangulation Risk	LOW-MODERATE — Source hierarchy disclosure is most significant in nuclear and WMD sections; low risk for standard government sources.	**LOW-MOD**	LOW-MODERATE CONFIDENCE

Part IX: Recommendations

The following recommendations are calibrated to an author who has already published the repository publicly. The primary concern is risk awareness for future series design, not retraction of existing material.

> **DOCUMENTED CONSTRAINT — WHAT CANNOT BE REMEDIATED**
> The repository is public, indexed by GitHub search, and accessible to any OSINT collection program. Official reporting on adversary OSINT operations is consistent with the judgment that what is published should be treated as already collected. Retraction is assessed with high confidence to carry no CI benefit and significant academic cost. The available evidence does not support retraction as a viable or effective remediation measure.

9.1 For Future Series Work

- Decouple the dependency graph from the public README. The reading order and cross-reference architecture is the mechanism that transforms individual papers into an integrated intelligence package.
- Separate high-granularity targeting matrices from methodology documentation. The SENI Interactive Map and the 327-node SENI-01 matrix constitute the highest single-session utility items. Future versions should consider abstracting targeting logic without publishing georeferenced node identification at current granularity.
- Reduce failure mode specificity in publicly published methodology documents. The analytic framework in ATTRIBUTION-01 and CSE-01 can be presented at a level useful to legitimate policy audiences without the seven named failure modes functioning as an operationalized evasion manual.
- Treat gap acknowledgments as a separate internal document. The explicit LOW CONFIDENCE disclosures and 'what would change this judgment' requirements are valuable for analytic integrity but carry disproportionate adversary utility in the indicator/signpost format introduced by EST-01.
- Apply the INFRA-01 predicate methodology more selectively in public versions. The AIS linkage methodology and BIS/OFAC sequencing detail provide adversary shipping operators a calibration target for defeating AIS-based enforcement predicates.

9.2 For Academic Submission (SSRN)

SSRN publication does not materially increase CI exposure — the GitHub repository is already indexed and should be treated as already collected. SSRN adds legitimate academic credibility and attribution permanence, which are net positives for the series. Proceed with SSRN publication as planned.

9.3 For Georgetown SSP Application Context

The portfolio's CI exposure is a byproduct of its analytical sophistication, not a deficiency. A doctoral program reviewer assessing this work will recognize the methodology rigor, the confidence

discipline, and the failure mode acknowledgments as markers of serious analytic training. The production of this CI assessment — a rigorous self-evaluation of an open-source research series' exposure profile, now including a formal legal analysis — is itself evidence of the operational security awareness and professional judgment the SSP program selects for. Including a brief reference to this self-assessment in the portfolio cover letter is recommended.

9.4 For Security Clearance Adjudication

The Legal Analysis in Part IV establishes that no WP-2026 content implicates any criminal statute or clearance-disqualifying act. The series is entirely open-source in derivation, protected under the First Amendment, and produced in the author's personal academic capacity. Proactive disclosure of the series in SF-86 and adjudication proceedings, accompanied by this CI Assessment, is recommended. The self-assessment posture demonstrates the analytic discipline and security awareness that adjudicative guidelines identify as favorable factors. Available DCSA/DSS adjudicative practice is consistent with a favorable characterization. [MODERATE CONFIDENCE, Analytically Inferred from published adjudicative standards]

Part X: Final Judgment

The WP-2026 series represents genuine analytical work at a level that creates real CI exposure precisely because it is sophisticated enough to be useful. The exposure is not the result of carelessness. It is the inherent tension between open-source policy research and the operational specificity required to make that research credible and actionable.

Official reporting on adversary OSINT collection practices is consistent with the judgment that the series is already collected by adversary OSINT programs. The highest-priority CI risks — the SENI Interactive Map, the SENI-01 node targeting logic, the ATTRIBUTION-01 failure mode taxonomy, and the MAXPRESS-01 execution sequencing — are assessed as very likely already part of the open-source analytical landscape that sophisticated adversary services monitor systematically. [MODERATE CONFIDENCE, ANALYTICALLY INFERRED]

The available evidence supports a moderate-confidence judgment that adversary awareness of this analytical architecture is unlikely to defeat the enforcement mechanisms the series documents. Those mechanisms operate through structural legal authorities and institutional capacity, not through information asymmetry. Knowing the analytical framework does not transfer the institutional capacity required to defeat it. [MODERATE CONFIDENCE, ANALYTICALLY INFERRED]

The legal exposure assessment (Part IV) is the clearest finding in this document: WP-2026 is legally unambiguous. No statute identified in the legal analysis applies to publicly derived, academically produced national security policy research. The content is constitutionally protected. The methodology is defensible. The author's posture — producing a rigorous public CI self-assessment alongside the series — is itself a marker of the analytic and professional standards the work is designed to demonstrate.

The actionable CI value of this assessment is prospective. It establishes a baseline for how to structure future integrated policy research series to preserve analytical depth while reducing specific exposure vectors identified here.

> **SERIES STATUS — V3.0 FINAL ASSESSMENT**
>
> **CI Exposure:** Significant at series level; manageable at individual paper level. Not addressable through retraction.
>
> **Legal Exposure:** Very low. No applicable statute implicated. First Amendment protections apply. Proceed with SSRN submission.
>
> **Academic Submission:** Proceed. SSRN adds credibility without materially increasing CI exposure.
>
> **Security Clearance:** Proactive disclosure recommended. CI Assessment supports favorable adjudicative characterization.

END OF DOCUMENT — WP-2026-CI-ASSESSMENT v3.0 — MARCH 2026 — UNCLASSIFIED // OPEN SOURCE ANALYTIC PRODUCT